

November

20

Born this day

1889 Edwin Hubble, US astronomer. He discovered galaxies beyond the Milky Way and devised a way to classify them based on their shape.

Medal of Freedom

Award-winning US activist and journalist Gloria Steinem received the Medal of Freedom from US president Barack Obama in recognition of her role in the women's liberation movement and campaigns for women's rights.



2013

1866

Whirligig wonder

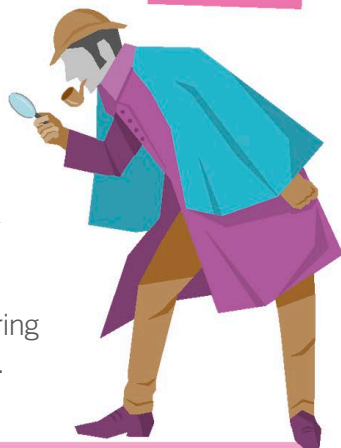
The patent was granted for the whirligig, better known as the yo-yo. This popular spinning toy was invented by Americans James L Haven and Charles Hettrick, but basic variations had existed since ancient times.



Sherlock Holmes

A Study in Scarlet, the first book to feature the fictional detective Sherlock Holmes, was accepted by London-based publishers Ward, Lock & Co. British author Arthur Conan Doyle wrote 60 stories featuring this beloved character.

1886



Also on this day

1969 Indigenous American activists gathered on Alcatraz Island, a former US prison base in San Francisco Bay, to protest against their unfair treatment by the US government and demand the return of their former land, including this island.

2019 A scientific study based on fossil findings revealed that for 70 million years, prehistoric snake species had lived with back legs.